

MONITORING, EVALUATION AND OUTCOMES

RESULTS CHAIN → CLASSIFY THE STATISTIC → INSTITUTIONAL MAP → EVALUATION CRITERIA SET → COVERAGE DISCIPLINE CARD → THREE BUDGETING MODES

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00RESULTS CHAIN

RESULTS CHAINMONEY, STAFF AND MATERIALS COMMITTED TO THE INTERVENTIONWHAT WAS ACTUALLY DONE, SUCH AS TRAINING CONDUCTED ORWHAT WAS DIRECTLY PRODUCED, SUCH AS KILOMETRES OF ROADTHE CHANGE IN THE TARGET POPULATION, SUCH AS TRAVEL

THE WIDER, LONGER-TERM CHANGE IN ACCESS, INCOME OR MOBILITYREPORTING STOPSMOST INDIAN SCHEME REPORTING HALTS AT THE OUTPUT RUNG

INPUT → money, staff and materials committed to the intervention

ACTIVITY: what was actually done, such as training conducted or pipes laid

OUTPUT: what was directly produced, such as kilometres of road or schools built

OUTCOME: the change in the target population, such as travel time or learning

IMPACT: the wider, longer-term change in access, income or mobility

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• INPUT → money, staff and materials committed to the intervention

• ACTIVITY: what was actually done, such as training conducted or pipes laid

POWER / PROCEDURE

• OUTPUT: what was directly produced, such as kilometres of road or schools built

• OUTCOME: the change in the target population, such as travel time or learning

CHECK / LIMIT

• IMPACT: the wider, longer-term change in access, income or mobility

• REPORTING STOPS → most Indian scheme reporting halts at the output rung

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• INPUT → money, staff and materials committed to the intervention

• ACTIVITY: what was actually done, such as training conducted or pipes laid

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REPORTING STOPS → most Indian scheme reporting halts at the output rung.

01

STAGE 01CLASSIFY THE STATISTIC

CLASSIFY THE STATISTICOUTPUT CLAIMSHARE OF HOUSEHOLDS COVERED; NUMBER OF FACILITIES CONSTRUCTEDOUTCOME CLAIMWATER QUALITY AT THE POINT OF USE; MEASURED LEARNINGIMPACT CLAIMMARKET ACCESS, HOUSEHOLD INCOME, MOBILITY OVER YEARS

EXAM MOVE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed	IMPACT CLAIM → market access, household income, mobility over years	OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed	IMPACT CLAIM → market access, household income, mobility over years
OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level	EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it	OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level	EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed

• OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level

POWER / PROCEDURE

• IMPACT CLAIM → market access, household income, mobility over years

• EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it

CHECK / LIMIT

• OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed

• OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• IMPACT CLAIM → market access, household income, mobility over years

• EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it.

02

STAGE 02INSTITUTIONAL MAP

INSTITUTIONAL MAPEVALUATION OFFICEATTACHED OFFICE OF NITI AAYOG; CONSTITUTED SEPTEMBER 2015FORMED BY MERGINGPROGRAM EVALUATION OFFICE AND INDEPENDENT EVALUATION OFFICEBUDGET FRAMEWORKMINISTRY OF FINANCE, BUDGET DIVISION; DUAL OUTPUT AND OUTCOME

DISTRICT PROGRAMME

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015	BUDGET FRAMEWORK → Ministry of Finance, Budget Division; dual output and outcome reporting	LIMIT → the evaluator produces evidence and cannot redesign the scheme	FORMED BY MERGING → Program Evaluation Office and Independent Evaluation Office
FORMED BY MERGING → Program Evaluation Office and Independent Evaluation Office	DISTRICT PROGRAMME → Champions of Change dashboard with delta ranking	EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015	BUDGET FRAMEWORK → Ministry of Finance, Budget Division; dual output and outcome reporting

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015

• FORMED BY MERGING → Program Evaluation Office and Independent Evaluation Office

POWER / PROCEDURE

• BUDGET FRAMEWORK → Ministry of Finance, Budget Division; dual output and outcome reporting

• DISTRICT PROGRAMME → Champions of Change dashboard with delta ranking

CHECK / LIMIT

• LIMIT → the evaluator produces evidence and cannot redesign the scheme

• EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• FORMED BY MERGING → Program Evaluation Office and Independent Evaluation Office

• BUDGET FRAMEWORK → Ministry of Finance, Budget Division; dual output and outcome reporting

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → the evaluator produces evidence and cannot redesign the scheme.

06

STAGE 06

DISTRICT AND BLOCK PROGRAMMES KEPT SEPARATE

DISTRICT AND BLOCK PROGRAMMES KEPT SEPARATE

DISTRICT PROGRAMME

112 DISTRICTS; 49 KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS; FIVE THEMES

FIVE THEMES

HEALTH AND NUTRITION; EDUCATION; AGRICULTURE AND WATER RESOURCES

FINANCIAL INCLUSION AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT; BASIC INFRASTRUCTURE

BLOCK PROGRAMME

513 BLOCKS IN CURRENT NITI AAYOG MATERIAL; A FINER

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes	FIVE THEMES → financial inclusion and skill development; basic infrastructure	ERROR TO AVOID → merging district and block counts or their indicator sets	FIVE THEMES → health and nutrition; education; agriculture and water resources
FIVE THEMES → health and nutrition; education; agriculture and water resources	BLOCK PROGRAMME → 513 blocks in current NITI Aayog material; a finer unit	DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes	FIVE THEMES → financial inclusion and skill development; basic infrastructure

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes

FIVE THEMES → health and nutrition; education; agriculture and water resources

POWER / PROCEDURE

FIVE THEMES → financial inclusion and skill development; basic infrastructure

BLOCK PROGRAMME → 513 blocks in current NITI Aayog material; a finer unit

CHECK / LIMIT

ERROR TO AVOID → merging district and block counts or their indicator sets

DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

FIVE THEMES → health and nutrition; education; agriculture and water resources

FIVE THEMES → financial inclusion and skill development; basic infrastructure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR TO AVOID → merging district and block counts or their indicator sets.

07

STAGE 07

RANKING DESIGN

RANKING DESIGN

ABSOLUTE RANKING

COMPARES PRESENT LEVEL; ALREADY-ADVANTAGED UNITS STAY ON TOP

DELTA RANKING

COMPARES THE RATE OF IMPROVEMENT OVER A DEFINED PERIOD

A HISTORICALLY DISADVANTAGED DISTRICT IS NOT PERMANENTLY PLACED AT

BASELINE UNDERSTATEMENT INFLATES APPARENT IMPROVEMENT

CAREFUL BASELINE-SETTING PLUS INDEPENDENT VALIDATION OF THE DATA

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top	GAIN → a historically disadvantaged district is not permanently placed at the bottom	CONDITION → careful baseline-setting plus independent validation of the data	DELTA RANKING → compares the rate of improvement over a defined period
DELTA RANKING → compares the rate of improvement over a defined period	RISK → baseline understatement inflates apparent improvement	ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top	GAIN → a historically disadvantaged district is not permanently placed at the bottom

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top

DELTA RANKING → compares the rate of improvement over a defined period

POWER / PROCEDURE

GAIN → a historically disadvantaged district is not permanently placed at the bottom

RISK → baseline understatement inflates apparent improvement

CHECK / LIMIT

CONDITION → careful baseline-setting plus independent validation of the data

ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

DELTA RANKING → compares the rate of improvement over a defined period

GAIN → a historically disadvantaged district is not permanently placed at the bottom

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONDITION → careful baseline-setting plus independent validation of the data.

08

STAGE 08

MONITORING AGAINST EVALUATION

MONITORING AGAINST EVALUATION

CONTINUOUS, HIGH FREQUENCY, TYPICALLY SELF-REPORTED ADMINISTRATIVE DATA

ITS USE

RAPID COURSE CORRECTION WHILE THE PROGRAMME IS RUNNING

PERIODIC, OFTEN INDEPENDENT, ASSESSES WHETHER OUTCOMES WERE ACHIEVED

SCHEME REDESIGN AND RESOURCE REALLOCATION AFTER THE EVIDENCE IS

NEITHER SUBSTITUTES FOR THE OTHER AND EACH FAILS IN

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
MONITORING → continuous, high frequency, typically self-reported administrative data	EVALUATION → periodic, often independent, assesses whether outcomes were achieved	RULE → neither substitutes for the other and each fails in a different way	ITS USE → rapid course correction while the programme is running
ITS USE → rapid course correction while the programme is running	ITS USE → scheme redesign and resource reallocation after the evidence is in	MONITORING → continuous, high frequency, typically self-reported administrative data	EVALUATION → periodic, often independent, assesses whether outcomes were achieved

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

MONITORING → continuous, high frequency, typically self-reported administrative data

ITS USE → rapid course correction while the programme is running

POWER / PROCEDURE

EVALUATION → periodic, often independent, assesses whether outcomes were achieved

ITS USE → scheme redesign and resource reallocation after the evidence is in

CHECK / LIMIT

RULE → neither substitutes for the other and each fails in a different way

MONITORING → continuous, high frequency, typically self-reported administrative data

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

ITS USE → rapid course correction while the programme is running

EVALUATION → periodic, often independent, assesses whether outcomes were achieved

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → neither substitutes for the other and each fails in a different way.

09

STAGE 09

METHOD AND LIMIT TABLE

METHOD AND LIMIT TABLE

BEFORE AND AFTER

SHOWS MOVEMENT; CANNOT SEPARATE THE INTERVENTION FROM EVERYTHING ELSE

WITH AND WITHOUT

PLAUSIBLE COUNTERFACTUAL; THE COMPARISON GROUP MAY DIFFER SYSTEMATICALLY

RANDOMISED TRIAL

CAUSAL EFFECT FOR THE DESIGN STUDIED; LIMITED EXTERNAL VALIDITY

CAUSAL INFERENCE WITHOUT RANDOMISATION; ASSUMPTIONS CAN FAIL

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else	RANDOMISED TRIAL → causal effect for the design studied; limited external validity	PROCESS EVALUATION → explains why an outcome occurred; no effect size	BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else
WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically	QUASI-EXPERIMENTAL → causal inference without randomisation; assumptions can fail	ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive	WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else

WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically

POWER / PROCEDURE

RANDOMISED TRIAL → causal effect for the design studied; limited external validity

QUASI-EXPERIMENTAL → causal inference without randomisation; assumptions can fail

CHECK / LIMIT

PROCESS EVALUATION → explains why an outcome occurred; no effect size

ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else

WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically

MONITORING, EVALUATION AND OUTCOMES • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5568-8802 of 11586 • continues below

BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else	RANDOMISED TRIAL → causal effect for the design studied; limited external validity	PROCESS EVALUATION → explains why an outcome occurred; no effect size	BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else
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CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else • WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically	POWER / PROCEDURE • RANDOMISED TRIAL → causal effect for the design studied; limited external validity • QUASI-EXPERIMENTAL → causal inference without randomisation; assumptions can fail	CHECK / LIMIT • PROCESS EVALUATION → explains why an outcome occurred; no effect size • ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else • WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive.			

10

STAGE 10 INDICATOR FAILURE MODES AND CORRECTIONS			
INDICATOR FAILURE MODES AND CORRECTIONS	A MEASURE WITH CONSEQUENCES IS PRODUCED RATHER THAN OBSERVED	THE JUDGED ENTITY GENERATES THE NUMBER; VALIDATE A SAMPLE	AGGREGATION MASKING
EFFORT MOVES TO WHAT IS COUNTED; ADD QUALITY AND	SELECTION EFFECTS		THE AVERAGE HIDES BLOCK AND GROUP FAILURE; DISAGGREGATE BY
OUTPUT SUBSTITUTION			
GOODHART → a measure with consequences is produced rather than observed; use a basket	SELF-REPORTED → the judged entity generates the number; validate a sample independently	AGGREGATION MASKING → the average hides block and group failure; disaggregate by rule	OUTPUT SUBSTITUTION → effort moves to what is counted; add quality and outcome measures
			SELECTION EFFECTS → only reachable beneficiaries are measured; report drop-off
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • GOODHART → a measure with consequences is produced rather than observed; use a basket • SELF-REPORTED → the judged entity generates the number; validate a sample independently	POWER / PROCEDURE • AGGREGATION MASKING → the average hides block and group failure; disaggregate by rule • OUTPUT SUBSTITUTION → effort moves to what is counted; add quality and outcome measures	CHECK / LIMIT • SELECTION EFFECTS → only reachable beneficiaries are measured; report drop-off • DEFINITION DRIFT → the definition changes between years; publish definitions and breaks	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • GOODHART → a measure with consequences is produced rather than observed; use a basket • SELF-REPORTED → the judged entity generates the number; validate a sample independently
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AGGREGATION MASKING → the average hides block and group failure; disaggregate by rule.			

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR AN EVALUATE DEMAND			
ANSWER SPINE FOR AN EVALUATE DEMAND	SAY WHAT AN OUTPUT CLAIM PROVES AND WHAT IT	PLACE THE EVIDENCE ON THE RESULTS CHAIN AND NAME	STATE THE COUNTERFACTUAL REQUIRED AND THE GAMING RISK IN
			GRADED VERDICT ABOUT THE EVALUATION DESIGN AS MUCH AS
OPEN → say what an output claim proves and what it does not, before citing	BUILD → place the evidence on the results chain and name the missing baseline	CORRECT → state the counterfactual required and the gaming risk in the indicator	CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • OPEN → say what an output claim proves and what it does not, before citing anything • BUILD → place the evidence on the results chain and name the missing baseline	POWER / PROCEDURE • CORRECT → state the counterfactual required and the gaming risk in the indicator • CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme	CHECK / LIMIT • OPEN → say what an output claim proves and what it does not, before citing anything • BUILD → place the evidence on the results chain and name the missing baseline	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • CORRECT → state the counterfactual required and the gaming risk in the indicator • CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme.			

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE DISTINCTION BETWEEN MONITORING AND EVALUATION MAPS ONTO A

DELTA-RANKING'S INCENTIVE-COMPATIBILITY (REWARDING IMPROVEMENT REGARDLESS OF STARTING

OUTCOME BUDGETING'S FULL MATURITY REQUIRES CREDIBLE CAUSAL ATTRIBUTION (SHOWING

DMEO WAS FORMED IN 2015 SPECIFICALLY BY MERGING THE

THE OUTPUT-OUTCOME MONITORING FRAMEWORK IS ISSUED/UPDATED BY THE MINISTRY

THE ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS PROGRAMME'S DASHBOARD ARCHITECTURE (MONTHLY OFFICER-REPORTED

A DISTRICT SHOWING STRONG MONTH-ON-MONTH IMPROVEMENT IN AN ADP

OPTIONAL INSTITUTIONAL DEPTH

• CAUTION: The distinction between monitoring and evaluation maps onto a broader governance-design

• CAUTION: Delta-ranking's incentive-compatibility (rewarding improvement regardless of starting

• CAUTION: Outcome budgeting's full maturity requires credible causal attribution (showing the

• DMEO was formed in 2015 specifically by merging the Programme Evaluation Organisation

STATUS / DATA CLAIM LIMIT

• The Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework is issued/updated by the Ministry of Finance's

• The Aspirational Districts Programme's dashboard architecture (monthly officer-reported

• CAUTION: A district showing strong month-on-month improvement in an ADP health KPI despite a low

• CAUTION: Boundary case: a district reporting an implausibly large one-month KPI jump raises a

COMPARATIVE GOVERNANCE NUANCE

• CAUTION: A DMEO third-party evaluation finding a scheme's outputs fully achieved but its

• CAUTION: High-frequency, self-reported monitoring (ADP-style) trades some data rigor for speed

• CAUTION: Outcome budgeting's causal-attribution demands are methodologically harder to satisfy

• CAUTION: Delta-ranking's fairness benefit (not penalising historical disadvantage) must be

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.